

SEEN FROM THE OPTIMIST'S TOWER

The pacifist is the fellow who holds your hands and begs you to keep calm while some other chap proceeds to knock the stuffing out of you.

The pacifist might also be defined as the man who considers a patriot to be one who firmly believes that God and the Kaiser run a joint-stock human butcher shop, while the jingo is one who is fool enough to believe that America has any rights under the sun.

A Portland preacher with a name like some place in central Europe thinks that churches should not hang out American flags for fear their act might be like flaunting a red flag in front of a bull. Dr. Kline pertinently asked: "Who is the bull?"

And now some erudite Chicago doctor breaks out in a new place with the advice that, when you kiss your wife or your best girl, you strain the osculation through a piece of gauze wire. Be sure that you have the gauze fine enough to snare the microbes by the gills, otherwise the aforesaid osculatory process is extremely unsanitary.

The Optimist is of the private opinion that our Chicago doctor either is a confirmed old bachelor with a mug that would sour milk, or drive one of the fair sex into hysterics; or that his best girl has recently gone back on him, and he can't get over the grouch.

Scientists tell us that in man, as in animals, the senses of taste and smell were once far more strongly developed than at present. Now when a dog meets a stranger he sniffs at him, and if he decides that the man is all right he proceeds to lick his hand. In reality, he smells him first, then tastes him. Once man followed the same program. The kiss was literally the lover's tasting of the lips of his sweetheart. Subconsciously the same process takes place today, hence the special attraction in billing and cooing.

Now, just for a minute, imagine yourself condemned to taste your ice cream or your banana sundae through a wire gauze! As Pat said about civilizing Ireland, "It can't be did!" No more can any blooming Chicago M. D. persuade any red blooded young man to strain his sweetheart's kisses—microbes or no microbes.

When it comes to the young ladies—that is another story. Once in a while some fellow comes into Optimist's office so redolent of bad tobacco that when he is gone your scribe is compelled to ventilate—and sometimes is tempted to fumigate—to get rid of the smell. How can some sweet, dainty little piece of femininity, whose breath is as fragrant as the perfume of the spring violets, stand to have a mug that would shame a soap factory slobbering over her? I have always opposed the false "two standard" idea. When man and woman come to stand on a parity, and the husband feels himself bound to do nothing that he would not demand of his wife, there will be more happy homes and less broken hearts.

Just in this connection, fellow, why don't you start right by acknowledging your wife's claim to be equal partner in the home firm? The fellow who carries the pocket-book, pays all the bills, compels his wife to come begging when she wants anything of her own, and who kicks so over giving her five dollars for a new dress that her life is a round of rags or of humiliations, does not deserve to have a wife. It's a mighty poor woman who does not carry more than her share of the family burden; and she is entitled, as her own just right, to as free access to the family purse as you have. But the double standard idea begins by the male Lord of Creation arrogating to himself the right to certain filthy habits which he would not tolerate for a minute in his life's partner, and ends with his hogging everything under the sun, and then wondering what in thunder has happened when his wife is driven to desperation.

If I had to kiss what some women run up against I'd want not only a wire gauze, but a bottle of smelling salts and a quart of formaldehyde thrown in to kill the flavor.

The cover of the April "World's Work" bears the following message: "AMERICA IN THE BATTLE LINE OF DEMOCRACY. That the world shall, under God, have a new birth of freedom, and that government of the people, by the people, for the people, shall not perish from the earth."

It is becoming more and more apparent that the present world war is the conflict of democracy against militarism and autocracy. It has resulted in the freedom of Russia. But now the militaristic forces of the central empires are massing for a great drive against Petrograd which, it is hoped, will kill the spirit of revolution, and restore the German party in Russia to power. Germany has turned her attention to the new world, and, should she win in this conflict, it would mean the downfall of all the free peoples of Europe, and the beginning of a world struggle between America and the Teuton beside which even this great war would pale into insignificance. On the other hand, should Germany lose, the result will be the downfall of the military caste and the dawn of a better day of German democracy. A Germany under the sway of Prussian militarism and governed by the philosophy of a Nietzsche and a Treitsche is a menace to the rights of humanity throughout the whole world; but a Germany governed by the loyal, true-hearted, friendly German people will be a world-wide blessing, yielding inestimable good to the children of men.

THE OPTIMIST.

Little Girl Had Croup

Every mother knows and fears croup. Mrs. R. M. Raney, R. F. D. 2, Stanford, Ky., writes: "My little girl had been having croup every few nights. I began to give her a few drops of Foley's Honey and Tar Compound every two or three hours, and that night she slept well, never coughed any, and the next day her cold was gone. To all of my friends I am saying, 'Get a bottle of Foley's Honey and Tar for la grippe, coughs, colds and croup. A genuine cure.'"

—Jones Drug Co.

THE CAUSE OF WAR

Claude Howard Answers Letter in Interesting Fashion

Mulino, Ore., March 26, 1917.

To the editor:

I would like to answer the question of Mrs. Viola Burr regarding the cause of war. Modern wars are the direct result of capitalism, an economic system whose base rests upon the principle of rent of land, interest upon money and profits upon merchandise. Very few people understand the ultimate effect upon a people of producing their commodities for a profit.

Statistics show that the average wage paid to the working man in the United States is \$1.50 per day. While the average price the consumer pays for the products of each day's work is \$10.50 (statistics of 1900 census). Here is a profit of \$9 on each day's work which goes to the wealthy and non-producing classes, who constitute over 10 per cent of the people. The other 90 per cent, or the working people, cannot buy of the results of their labor except to the extent of their income of \$1.50 per day when they are working. This leaves in the hands of the manufacturing and merchant classes a large surplus of goods which they cannot sell because the large mass of the people are too poor to buy. It is obvious that the wealthy class are too few in number to consume 90 per cent of the products of labor, no matter how extravagantly they live.

There is only one recourse; to sell to foreign countries and maintain a foreign commerce. But that is only a temporary expedient, as the nations which buy would soon have their money gone unless they, too, commence to ship goods to some other country to get their funds back. Karl Marx, the late German writer upon economics, asked the people of the earth this question: "When every nation confronts every other nation with a large surplus of goods what are they going to do?" That question has non-plussed the most astute men of today and they have never answered it. And that is the condition that now exists. There is, as a consequence, a struggle between the capitalists of various nations for the markets of the world. They want territory and other lands so they can sell goods to them and keep out the traders of other nations. England was the first nation to develop capitalism. As a consequence there is no country in all Europe where the

people live in such dire distress as they do in England and where also a few of the world's richest men hold sway.

In Germany, on the other hand, the wealthy class is few in numbers, contented to live plainly and satisfied with slow accumulations. They were wise enough to see that socialism made for a strong and powerful nation. It may surprise some people to know that for commercial and military purposes Germany is a socialist state. Twenty-five years ago wages were about 50 cents a day and unemployment great. At the outbreak of the war the wages had been raised to about \$2 per day and employment was provided for everyone in Germany. The Kaiser would not allow the trusts to raise prices upon the poor people so that their wages were really equal to \$3 a day. Germany had beaten England at her own game.

A few years ago the Kaiser said that his son would be the last emperor Germany would ever have, an indirect way of saying that the people of Germany would make Germany a socialist republic in the future. That was the one thing which capitalists and aristocracy of the other nations did not want. The desire to crush Germany and prevent any further increase in the people's power was the hidden cause of the European war.

The capitalists here have much the same reasons for desiring Germany's downfall as they have across the water. They wish the war continued so they can sell more munitions and they fear that if the Triple Entente loses, the people will repudiate their bonds, of which American capitalists have bought large quantities. Neither the people or the Kaiser of Germany want war with us and the people of America don't want war with Germany. But a group of men small in numbers but powerful in wealth and ownership of most of our sources of information are determined upon war to save their bonds and profits. They care nothing for American lives or the best interests of our nation.

I say it advisedly that if for any reason the capitalists of America should desire to change their support over to the German side in that great conflict, that we soon would notice an astonishing change in the character of the press reports. Germany might sink all our ships she wanted and her conduct would be glossed over with excuses. On the other hand we would hear much about the ruthlessness of England and the papers would commence to foment hate against England and her allies. The remedy for all of this is for the people to own and operate their public utilities, and sell the products of the labor to themselves at labor cost.

CLAUDE HOWARD.

REPORTERS, REAL AND REEL

There's a Vast Difference in the Pay Envelope and Otherwise

According to a story from Chicago, a reporter paid for a taxicab ride with six potatoes, using a market basket as a purse. We'd like to believe the tale, but we've been a reporter so long that we're from Missouri, says the New York American.

We never saw a reporter yet wealthy enough to own six potatoes all at one time, and we never saw any one who needed a market basket to carry his wage. If there were no germs except in money a reporter would run as little danger of infection as an angel would.

Furthermore, reporters don't ride in taxicabs unless they're movie reporters. There's as much difference between a movie reporter and a regular reporter as there is between a handcar and the Twentieth Century limited.

If somebody handed a regular reporter a movie reporter's pay envelope by mistake he'd start right in framing up an alibi to prove he wasn't there when the bank was robbed.

A movie reporter has nothing to do but rescue the heroine and complain to his friends about how she and the director between them are always trying to crab his act. The only heroine a regular reporter rescues is his landlady—he rescues her from the disgrace of dying rich by neglecting to pay his rent.

The reporter writes a lot about money, even though he sees mighty little of it. For example, almost every day he has to write a story about "Jesse Bacmore, Boy Plunger, Wins \$2,000,000 in Wall Street," and the only money he himself ever wins is 60 cents in chips playing poker with the gang in the back room, and more than likely the banker will say he can't cash 'em till Saturday, and on Saturday he forgets 'em.

Money may talk, but it never gets hoarse talking to a reporter. They don't meet often enough.

WANT GAME WARDEN

Man Live Wires Indorsed Seems Certain of Being Appointed

Clackamas county is without a deputy game and fish warden, and the loss of many fish from the streams of the county has been charged to this condition. The Clackamas County Anglers' association has sent a written appeal to the state game warden, Carl D. Shoemaker, asking that some means be devised for the protection of the fish planted last year.

The association points out in its communication that some of the many thousands of fish planted last year have been caught by Portland anglers, fishing in the Molalla and Clackamas rivers and in Mill creek and Clear creek. The association provides severe penalties for infraction of the game and fish laws by its own members and charges Portland anglers with catching the undersized trout.

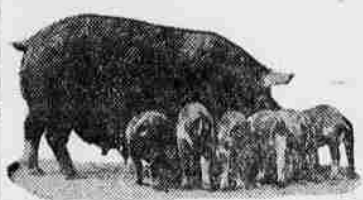
The game warden, it is understood, will have a deputy in this field within a short time, and with the appointment in view the Live Wires of the Commercial club have indorsed Bert Jewell, who was deputy for this county last year.

FARMING AND LIVE STOCK

SELECTING BROOD SOWS.

Points That Indicate Fecundity and Good Constitution.

Prospective brood sows should be selected from the best animals in the herd, always taking those whose mothers are gentle, good milkers and prolific, writes a correspondent of the American Agriculturist. The sow should have a smoother forehead and lighter, finer neck than the male. The forehead should be broad between the eyes, the throat clean and trim, neck moderately thin, shoulders smooth and deep, the back wide and straight and deeply fleshed with ribs well sprung; sides straight and deep, hams deep and well rounded, body rather long, but compact, and legs moderately short and stout. Select those with wide, deep chests and well sprung ribs, as it indicates strong constitution, a very important essential with good brood sows. It is not the fat, plump sows of the herd that make the best mothers, but rather the long bodied, more vigorous ones which show quality and have good grazing and feeding powers. Brood sows should not be overfed



The successful breeder will never change an old sow for a young gilt until he is obliged to. The former will give two good litters annually, one early in the spring and the other in September or October. Handle the brood sows carefully at all times and keep them as gentle as possible. The picture shows mature brood sow with litter.

and delicate, as it is apt to lead to a weak constitution and possibly sterility.

Previous to farrowing the main demands upon a brood sow are those for building up new tissue. This means there should be plenty of protein in the ration, secured by feeding nitrogenous feeds. A few days previous to farrowing change to a sloppy food and bulky in character, like bran, and do not feed overgenerously. This will assist in avoiding constipation, so likely to occur at farrowing time and soon after. A box of charcoal, salt and ashes should be kept where they can get at it at all times summer or winter. A farmer who gives sows access to this mixture and varies the ration occasionally, providing sufficient protein, will not be troubled with sows eating their pigs.

Immediately after farrowing feed the sow sparingly. The first day or two give her nothing but a thin slop. Then a little more nutritive food can be given, like skim milk along with equal parts of cornmeal and middlings. By the time the pigs are two weeks old the sow should receive a full ration, practically all she will eat up clean. For the demands upon her at this time, if she has a good litter, are heavy, and there is nothing more important in the swine business than giving the youngsters a good start.

A good breeding sow should be kept in the herd as long as she gives good service, which may be six to eight years.

Remedy For Cowpox.

Cowpox is a highly infectious disease and must run its course. It is easily spread among animals, and even man may become infected if the discharge gets into a fresh wound on the hands, in which case regular vaccination, the same as for smallpox, results. Bathe under twice a day with a warm 5 per cent solution of creolin and when dry apply a little carbolic vaseline. Affected animals should be milked and cared for after the others to avoid infecting healthy ones. The hands should also be washed in the creolin solution after working with them. It is well to separate the diseased ones entirely from the healthy to prevent spreading.

Rest For the Cow.

To give the calf and its mother a fair chance a cow should be carefully dried off six weeks before the date of calving. This allows her to feed well her unborn calf and to get ready for her period of milk production.—Wisconsin Agricultural College.

LIVE STOCK NOTES.

Be very careful in the selection of the sire for your pigs. Use the best pure bred of your desired breed within reach. Good blood goes a long way to make for success in litters. Study your horses. Some require more roughage than others to keep them in condition. Keep the ewes very thrifty by watchful, careful feeding. Be sure that your ewes do not crowd through narrow doors. Crowding or jamming may kill an unborn lamb and possibly the ewe. If a pig has a cough give it some oilmeal in its feed. Oilmeal is a laxative, and it will often help a slight cold. Keep the colts well bedded and clean. A mature laden colt is a rebuke to its owner.

FORMING TRADE RESERVE

Secretary of Civil Service Force Gets Instructions from Washington

From the civil service commission at Washington the local secretary, W. B. Howell, has received instruction on how to proceed with the enlistment of a reserve force of artisans to supply the government in case of need. In addition to asking for a reserve list the federal authorities are highly anxious to secure mechanical and other trade help at once and have furnished Mr. Howell of the postoffice

Easter Greetings

To Our Many Friends and Loyal Customers



YOU will find us still at the same busy "corner" and enjoying a good lively business.

Although prices on foodstuffs are very high, we are in a position to sell you a great many articles that have advanced, at the same old prices.

Hoping for a continuance of your valued patronage, we are always at your service.

The Hub Grocery Co.

M. E. Bunn

Seventh and Center Streets

C. H. Dickey

here with the necessary blanks and information for applicants.

It is proposed to list mechanics not already working on government contracts, who would be willing to accept government employment at once, and also those who would not accept immediate employment, but who would accept in case the country urgently needed their services.

Mr. Howell has been requested to interview labor, fraternal and other organizations in Oregon City and

Clackamas county with a view to having them announce to their members the commission's intention and endeavor to secure their co-operation. Individual workmen are also to be interested in the work. Mr. Howell has a supply of application cards and is anxious to discuss the government work and plans with anyone interested.

Milwaukie Bank Wins

In the case of the First State bank

of Milwaukie against George Moulton and S. M. Cozad, Judge Campbell Saturday signed a judgment order in favor of the bank for \$240 and interest, with \$25 attorney fees. The judgment orders the sale of property to satisfy the claim.

In view of the complete satisfaction of the claim of Sarah A. Hyatt against W. J. Faubion, Judge Campbell Saturday ordered the dismissal of the suit brought by Mrs. Hyatt.

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Charming Suits at \$14.65 to \$37.50
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We have struck the note of response in the hearts of many women already with our strongly appealing Spring display. This year, of all years, there seems to have crept into Suits, Coats and Dresses a deeper harmony with the associations of Spring. There is a wonderful nicety of stitching, workmanship, pleating and edging of every garment. Here you'll find styles becoming to all figures, and materials and colors to suit all tastes.

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—Coats

Of Spring-weight materials in the shades of the hour. Tweeds, Mixtures, Velours, etc. Smartest styles moderately priced from

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PERUNA in Your Home

A housewife must give the first aid in colds, coughs and other ailments. Her promptness in applying the remedy often saves a serious illness. Her experience with remedies has led her to know that PERUNA is always reliable, that she should have it on hand for the immediate treatment of coughs and colds, and that it is always to her.



Mrs. George Parker, 419 Water St., Metolite, Wis., writes: "We have used Peruna in our family for a number of years, and have found it a perfectly reliable medicine. It soon rid the system of any traces of a cold, and prevents serious consequences."

"I began using it for catarrh, which I suffered with a good many years, but had not been very serious until recently. Since I have taken Peruna the drooping in my throat has discontinued, and my head and nose are not so stopped up in the morning. I am pleased with the results, and shall continue to use it until I am entirely rid of catarrh. I heartily recommend it as an honest medicine."

"What it does for her it is ready to do for you."

Colds and Catarrh

The great weight of testimony that has accumulated in the 44 years that PERUNA has been on the market proves it, beyond question, to be the reliable family remedy, ever ready to take, preventing the serious effects of colds, coughs, grip and derangements of the digestive organs. This proof is published from time to time and many families have profited by it.

Remember you can obtain PERUNA in tablet form for your convenience. Carry it with you and be fortified against sudden attacks.

The Peruna Company, Columbus, Ohio

The Family Safeguard

The experience of one woman, given herewith, is typical of thousands of letters that reach the Peruna Company from grateful friends who have found their homes incomplete, and their family safety in danger without PERUNA.

